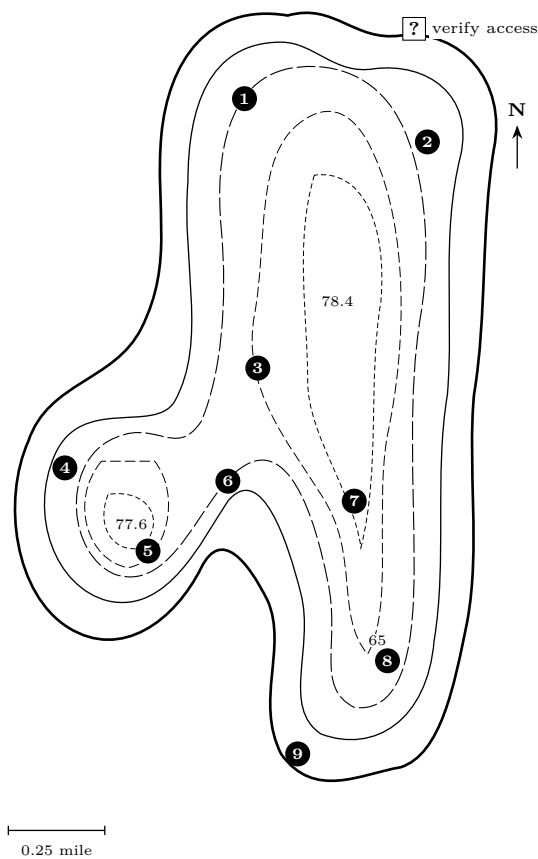


North is a deep drainage lake with two strongly defined basins joined through a narrow structural corridor. The historical survey shows abrupt edges, small humps and a south neck toward Mud Lake. Use those shapes as hypotheses; confirm today’s depth, vegetation, access and hazards yourself.

Identity	WBIC 850800; 440 acres
Depth	78.4 ft maximum
Bottom	50% sand; 30% gravel; 20% muck
Type	Drainage lake; DNR classifies it eutrophic
Current DNR fish record	Panfish, largemouth bass, smallmouth bass, northern pike and walleye
Access	DNR does not list a numbered landing on the facts page. Confirm legal public access before arrival; a historical road is not permission



Generalized depth contours: solid 10 ft; widely dashed 20 ft; long dash 40 ft; short dash 60 ft; labeled historical soundings. **Not for navigation.** Independently drafted from the Wisconsin Conservation Department sheet compiled in 1898 and revised in 1941; current shoreline/access context checked against 2024 USDA/FSA NAIP aerial orthophotography. No imagery is reproduced. A question mark means access must be independently verified.

Nine places to test, not promises

#	Area	Why test it	First pass
1	North flat	Broad shallow water meets the main basin.	Search for the current weed edge and bait; cover it without crossing beds.
2	Northeast break	Contours crowd the eastern shore.	Keep the boat outside, cast uphill, and identify contact depth.
3	Central channel edge	A structural corridor joins north and south water.	Scan both lips for bait or fish before committing.
4	West-lobe rim	A sharp outside curve enters the western basin.	Work from the shallow crown down through 20–40 ft.
5	West-lobe basin	A compact 77.6-ft bowl offers nearby deep water.	Scan for suspended life; do not fish empty depth.
6	Central saddle	The pinch between lobes concentrates routes, not necessarily fish.	Make controlled passes on each side and compare.
7	Southeast hump	Small isolated structure breaks the main basin wall.	Circle it to find the steep and windward faces.
8	South basin edge	A 65-ft pocket meets the lower taper.	Check low light and seasonal transitions; follow bait, not the printed number.
9	South neck	Shallow constriction toward Mud Lake.	Verify navigation, access and regulations before fishing moving-water edges.

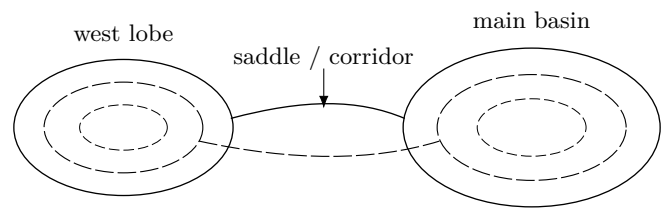
North Lake sequence

1. Confirm legal public access before towing or carrying a craft to the water. Read every posted ordinance and high-water notice.
2. Sample one lobe, the saddle and one eastern break. A lake-wide pattern needs repeated depth/bottom evidence, not one bite.
3. Because DNR classifies North as eutrophic, let current vegetation, oxygen, clarity and bait observations override the antique contour sheet.
4. DNR records Eurasian water-milfoil and zebra mussel. Inspect, remove and drain before transport; never move live fish away from the water.

ACCESS AND CONTOURS REQUIRE VERIFICATION

The source map began in 1898 and was revised in 1941. Its north road label does not establish a present public landing. Neither this redrawing nor an aerial image grants access. Confirm ownership, legal access, depth and hazards through current official information and direct observation.

Read two basins as a connected system



- 1. On the lake map, draw a route that samples location 5, then 6, then 3 without crossing the same contour more than necessary.
- 2. At location 6, mark one station on each lip of the saddle. Predict which lip receives today’s wind and which offers the quieter measurement station.
- 3. Compare locations 2 and 4. Circle the one with tighter contour spacing; write how much boat-position error you can tolerate before a cast misses the break.
- 4. Trace the shallowest apparent route between locations 8 and 9. List two reasons the historical route may not be safe or navigable now.

Prediction before launch

If the two lobes differ, I expect _____ to have clearer / warmer water because _____. I will test that claim with _____, not with the first bite alone.

Questions the antique contours cannot settle

Question	Direct check
Does the central corridor carry bait today?	Scan both lips on reciprocal headings; require repeatable marks before fishing.
Where does living vegetation end?	Measure the outside edge in each lobe; do not transfer one basin’s depth to the other.
Is the south neck lawful and passable?	Verify access, signs, depth, current and obstructions from a safe position; turn back if uncertain.

Measure both lobes the same way

- 1. **Choose four stations.** Use one protected shelf, the west-lobe rim, one saddle lip and an eastern main-basin break. Identify each by map number or lawful waypoint.
- 2. **Depth.** Stop safely outside traffic. Let sonar stabilize and repeat the pass on the reciprocal heading. With a marked sounding line, stop propulsion, wear a PFD and keep line away from hands, feet and propeller.
- 3. **Temperature.** Shade the thermometer. Measure surface, 5, 10 and 20 ft where possible, pausing for a stable reading. Use the same depths and wait time in each lobe; write “not measured” instead of estimating.
- 4. **Clarity.** From the shaded side, lower a standard black-and-white Secchi disk to disappearance, then raise it to reappearance. Average the two depths and repeat. Do not lean overboard in waves.
- 5. **Context.** Record wind, sky, recent rain, surface film, vegetation height, boat traffic and any current through the corridor.

Compare stations, not impressions
North’s basins may differ on the same day. Use the same tool, units and method at every station. Temperature and clarity do not by themselves prove adequate oxygen; measure oxygen with suitable calibrated equipment or leave it unknown.

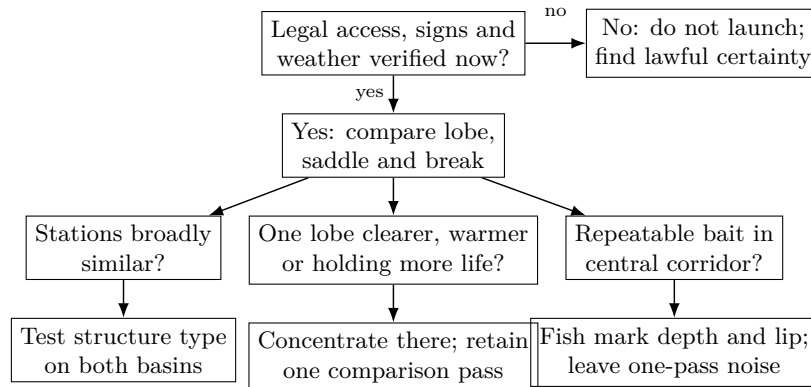
North Lake comparison log

Date/time	Station/lobe	Depth ft	Temp face/5/10/20 ft	sur- Secchi down/up/avg ft	Wind, growth, bait, confidence

Verification questions

- 1. Which measurement differed most between lobes? _____. Was the difference larger than repeated-measurement variation?
- 2. Did reciprocal depth passes agree within _____ ft? If not, name the likely source: slope, weeds, waves, heading or instrument setting.
- 3. Were repeatable bait marks above, within or below the fastest temperature change? _____. What evidence would change that answer?

Choose the next test from evidence



Access and weather gate

Verify on trip day	Evidence seen/heard	Go?
Legal public access and permission route		Yes / No
Exact-water rules; posted local restrictions		Yes / No
Forecast, current radar, wind direction/gusts		Yes / No
Lightning, fog, high-water or hazard notice		Yes / No
Craft, PFDs, lights, communication and return route		Yes / No

UNVERIFIED ACCESS MEANS NO TRIP

A road, worn path, map label or online pin is not permission. Confirm the launch and route through a current authoritative source and the signs on site. Recheck weather at the water. If access, visibility, waves or restrictions are uncertain, do not launch or return immediately.

Evidence-to-decision log

Time / map #	Claim tested	Evidence for and against	Next pass and why

2026–27 rules printed for departure planning

Bass	Harvest May 2, 2026–Mar. 7, 2027; 14 in minimum; 5 daily. Catch-and-release is open year-round unless otherwise noted.
Northern pike	May 2, 2026–Mar. 7, 2027; 26 in minimum; 2 daily.
Walleye group	May 2, 2026–Mar. 7, 2027; 18 in minimum; 3 daily.
Panfish	Open all year; no minimum; 25 daily.
Rock/yellow/white bass	Open all year; no minimum; unlimited.
Cisco/whitefish	Open all year; no minimum; 10 daily. Category does not prove presence.
Muskellunge	May 2–Dec. 31, 2026, open water only; 40 in minimum; 1 daily. Category does not prove presence.
Motor trolling	Allowed with up to 3 hooks, baits or lures per angler.

RECHECK BEFORE EVERY TRIP

These are the Wisconsin DNR lookup results for WBIC 850800 checked 26 July 2026. Verify the exact water, species and date in the live DNR rules. The DNR says listed regulation categories may not reflect fish actually present. Posted signs are the definitive practical check for slow-no-wake areas/hours, high-water restrictions and other local ordinances because the database may lag.

Evidence boundary

The current DNR lake record supports panfish, largemouth bass, smallmouth bass, northern pike and walleye. It does not resolve “panfish” into individual species. Do not treat regulation-only categories as an inventory. The provider-neutral evidence record is `research/lake-country-fishing/lakes-north.md`.

Primary sources

Wisconsin DNR Lake Page and historical contour sheet (WBIC 850800); Wisconsin DNR exact-water fishing-regulation lookup (checked 2026-07-26); Wisconsin DNR 2026–27 regulation changes; USDA/FSA 2024 NAIP via the Wisconsin statewide imagery service. Full URLs and limitations are in the research file.

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